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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 49266.11 ▲ 270.03 0.55%

NASDAQ 23480.02 ▼ 0.4%

STOXX 600 603.83 ▼ 0.2%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 12/32, yield 4.182%

OIL \$57.76 ▲ \$1.77

GOLD \$4,449.70 ▲ \$0.40

EURO \$1.1661

YEN 156.87

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Hangzhou-based** Geely is considering expanding into the U.S. in what would be a watershed for U.S. carmakers that view Chinese brands as a threat to the long-term stability of domestic names. **A1**

◆ **China said it would** re-view Meta's recent acquisition of AI startup Manus, firing a warning shot toward Chinese entrepreneurs lured by Silicon Valley riches. **B1**

◆ **Trump said Fannie Mae** and Freddie Mac would buy \$200 billion in mortgage bonds, part of a broader effort by the president to address a sharp rise in the cost to own a home. **A2**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed amid a rotation trade on Wall Street, leaving the S&P 500 virtually unchanged while the Dow rose 0.6% and the Nasdaq fell 0.4%. **B9**

◆ **GM said it would** book a \$6 billion charge on its fast-shrinking, unprofitable electric-vehicle business, the latest reckoning tied to the collapse of EVs in the U.S. **B1**

◆ **Rio Tinto and Glencore** are in talks about a deal that would create the world's largest mining company, with a market value of more than \$200 billion. **B1**

◆ **Paramount Skydance** continued pushing its \$779 billion bid for Warner Bros. Discovery a day after Warner said it would stick to its deal with Netflix. **B4**

◆ **Soho House's plan** to go private was checked when a lead investor said it couldn't meet its financial commitment by the expected closing date. **B1**

◆ **Shell said a weak** oil-trading performance would weigh on its earnings, compounding the challenge of falling prices. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **Law-enforcement** officials in Minnesota said the Trump administration blocked them from participating in an investigation into the fatal shooting of a woman by an ICE agent. **A1, A6**

◆ **Two people were shot** and injured by federal agents in Portland, Ore. **A6**

◆ **Trump withdrew** the U.S. from dozens of international organizations, including United Nations commissions and major bodies set up to tackle climate change. **A3**

◆ **Trump lashed out** at five GOP senators after they sided with Democrats to advance a motion to block him from taking further military action in Venezuela without explicit congressional approval. **A10**

◆ **Venezuela's regime** released five political prisoners and was expected to free many more, as it sought to appease the U.S. **A9**

◆ **Large groups** of protesters swept through Tehran, chanting antigovernment slogans in the biggest display of public discontent in years. **A7**

◆ **The House upheld** the president's vetoes on Republican-led bills to bring fresh water to eastern Colorado and expand reservation land for the Micosukee Tribe in Florida. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge ruled** that the prosecutor overseeing a civil-rights investigation into New York Attorney General Letitia James was serving unlawfully. **A3**

◆ **Since Dec. 24**, a postmark no longer shows the date mail was deposited with the U.S. Postal Service, erasing its authority as proof that an individual met a deadline. **A4**

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Federal agents confronted people Thursday in St. Paul, Minn., as they protested the killing of Renee Good by an ICE officer.

Minnesota Says Federal Officials Block State From Shooting Probe

White House gives support to ICE agent as protests grow over woman's killing

MINNEAPOLIS—Minnesota law-enforcement officials said Thursday that the FBI blocked them from participating in an investigation into

By Joseph De Avila,
Joe Barrett
and Michelle Hackman

the fatal shooting of a woman by an ICE agent, intensifying the dispute between the state and the federal government over the death.

Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz denounced the Federal Bureau

of Investigation's decision to exclude the state from the investigation, saying any probe that doesn't include state law enforcement can't be trusted. "It feels very, very difficult that we will get a fair outcome," Walz, a Democrat, said Thursday.

Vice President JD Vance defended the Immigration and Customs Enforcement agent and criticized the woman who was killed, Renee Nicole Good, calling her a "victim of left-wing ideology."

"I can believe that her death is a tragedy, while also recognizing that it's a tragedy of her own making," Vance, a Republican, said at the White House on Thursday.

Democratic leaders denounced the Trump adminis-

tration and its policies and called for a full investigation into the shooting.

"The killing of Renee Nicole Good was an abomination," said Rep. Hakeem Jeffries of New York, the House Democratic leader. "Blood is clearly on the hands of those individuals within the administration who've been pushing an extreme policy."

The FBI had originally agreed to a joint investigation on Wednesday, said Drew Evans, superintendent of the Minnesota Bureau of Criminal Apprehension. On Thursday, the FBI said it would solely handle the investigation and would no longer provide state law enforcement with access to case materials or evidence. "Without complete access

to the evidence, witnesses and information collected, we cannot meet the investigative standards that Minnesota law and the public demands," Drew Evans, the state agency's superintendent, said Thursday. "As a result, the BCA has reluctantly withdrawn from the investigation."

Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem said Minnesota law enforcement doesn't have any jurisdiction in the investigation. The FBI's Minneapolis office didn't respond to a request for comment.

The death of Good, who was 37 years old and a mother of three, has sparked protests in

◆ **Two shot by federal agent** in Portland, Ore..... A6

Venezuela Oil Plan Is Risk For U.S. Drillers

More supply could help drivers at the pump but strain domestic oil patch

By COLLIN EATON
AND KONRAD PUTZIER

Inflation-weary consumers finally have something to cheer about: cheap oil. But it comes at a cost.

Oil-producing regions such as West Texas and North Dakota are suffering from layoffs and slowing growth, and some research suggests the drop in prices hurts the U.S. economy as much as it helps.

President Trump said this week that the U.S. would receive 30 million to 50 million barrels of oil from Venezuela to sell on the open market, and would invest billions to restore the country's output. The new supply, coupled with a production boost in a country with one of the world's largest oil reserves, could mean cheaper oil and gas for consumers, while squeezing U.S. oil companies.

The developments with Venezuela come amid a monthslong fall in crude-oil prices, which stood at \$78 a barrel when Trump took office but have been idling for months at about \$60, near the industry's breakeven point. On Thursday, West Texas Intermediate oil traded at about \$58 a barrel. The drop in prices is due largely to a decision by the cartel of oil-producing countries known as OPEC to boost production last spring.

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◆ **Greg Ip: Low risk, low reward** in U.S. oil move... A8
◆ **Venezuela sets free five political prisoners**..... A9
◆ **U.S. targets shadow fleet** of oil tankers..... A9
◆ **GOP senators' votes** on war draw rebuke..... A10

Chinese Automaker Geely Aims To Make Cars in U.S.

By RYAN FELTON

China auto giant Geely is eyeing an expansion to the U.S., in what would be a watershed moment for domestic carmakers that view Chinese brands as an existential threat. Zhejiang Geely Holding Group is likely to make an announcement about a U.S. expansion within the next 24 to 36 months, said Ash Sutcliffe, Geely's global communications chief.

"The big question for us is when and where will we go to the U.S.A.," Sutcliffe said in an interview this week with Autoline Network at the Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas. Geely controls a broad portfolio of brands that make popular electric vehicles, plug-in hybrids and gas-powered cars.

Geely's expansion in the U.S. would represent the first major move by a Chinese brand to come into the country, which has imposed hefty tariffs on imports of Chinese-made vehicles and has a ban on Chinese connected-vehicle software in cars set to go into effect for the 2027 model year.

Chinese automakers have swallowed up market share in other countries around the world, a worrisome prospect for U.S. car executives who struggle to compete on production costs and vehicle technology.

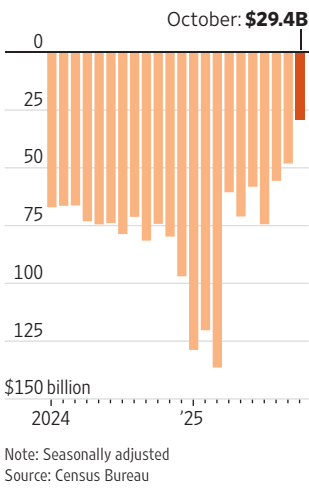
Unlike other Chinese competitors, Geely already has a small foothold in the U.S.

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Trade Gap Narrows

The U.S. trade deficit shrank dramatically in October to its lowest level since 2009. **A2**

U.S. trade deficit in goods and services, monthly



Note: Seasonally adjusted
Source: Census Bureau

The Battle Over Jimmy Buffett's Old Recording Studio

Late singer's fans rally to keep Key West space from becoming a bar

By JOHN M. CLARKE JR.

On a curvy dockside stretch in Key West, Fla., called Lazy Way Lane is a worn out white bunker building with no windows.

Beaten by sun and weather and plastered with stickers, the old shrimp icehouse is a piece of Florida and music history: Jimmy Buffett recorded dozens of albums there, hosting musicians including Toby Keith, Kenny Chesney, the Smashing Pumpkins and Alan Jackson.

But since his death in 2023,

the main thing it's been creating is trouble. And not the kind Buffett memorialized in songs like "Margaritaville" and "Why Don't We Get Drunk."

Shrimpbait Sound Studio was emptied and its lease with the city canceled last year. The building is in disrepair and Key West is considering what to do with the property. The city has asked the public for proposals.

Fans are feeling frisky about a plan to transform the building into a bar, campaign-

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Maduro Ouster Leaves Cuba Desperate, Closer to Collapse

By DEBORAH ACOSTA
AND JOSÉ DE CÓRDOBA

Elderly Cubans are digging through garbage for scraps of food in Havana. In the country's second city, Santiago, crowds have gathered, blaring music by Cuban exiles such as Gloria Estefan and Willy Chirino, who sings "Our day is coming soon."

The U.S. ouster of Venezuelan dictator Nicolás Maduro has jolted this country of fewer than 10 million people, which has long relied on Venezuela for oil imports that have barely kept its tiny economy from collapsing.

It opens a new and perilous

chapter for the island's Communist regime during an economic implosion that rivals the crisis suffered by Cuba after the collapse of the Soviet Union more than three decades ago.

In poorer cities, people are openly speculating about whether the U.S. will topple the government of Cuban President Miguel Díaz-Canel, the successor to Raúl and Fidel Castro, the siblings who led the Cuban Revolution in 1959 that sent shock waves across Latin America.

"They are nervous," Manuel Cuesta Morúa, a Havana-based political activist, said of the government. "Repres-

sion will increase, it's the typical response."

Cuba's state security apparatus has long had a tight grip on all levels of society, from workplaces to schools or concert halls. But Maduro's capture risks upending the government's control of every street, its deep surveillance system and its vast network of snitches, Cuban dissidents and former officials said.

Two days after Maduro's ouster, Reynaldo Flores was dealing with his fifth consecutive day without running water at his apartment in Havana. It is his new normal, along with the daily black-

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INSIDE



JASON GAY

The only thing crazier than Indiana football may be Nebraska basketball. **A16**



MANSION

Aspen vs. Palm Beach: Which luxury destination has the priciest homes? **M1**